world, remember our tradition of debate in an environment of respect and tolerance. By upholding it, by fighting for it, you will be repaying your teachers in this great institution, and your parents who worked so hard to send you here. And you will be doing our country a great patriotic service. Thank you and good luck.

Postscript: I knew this speech would be misinterpreted by the usual critics, but I had decided to look beyond them. Once again, many who did not read, criticized nevertheless. They felt I was complaining about India's intolerance when in fact the speech is about maintaining our tradition for tolerance. Some of the commentary bordered on the hilarious, essentially saying 'we are a tolerant nation, he accuses us of intolerance, so fire him' or words to that effect. What mattered most to me, however, was a one-liner from one of my staunchest young critics, my teenage son. From far away, he read my speech closely, and satisfied it met his exacting standards, he wrote, 'I am proud of you.'